

Sandshrew

The Earth rift's companion and the roster's tank. It holds ground, takes the hit meant for a friend, and makes the dirt around it hard to cross.

The Underroot's own answer to a charge. Sandshrew plants itself between the party and whatever is coming, and the ground it stands on stops being easy to cross.

SANDSHREW

Medium beast (Ground), unaligned ◆ Earth-rift companion

AC 17 (natural armor) **HP** 78 (12d8 + 24) **Speed** 30 ft., burrow 40 ft.

STR 18 **DEX** 14 **CON** 15 **INT** 6 **WIS** 12 **CHA** 10

Saves Str +7, Con +5 **Skills** Athletics +7, Perception +4

Vulnerable cold

Resist bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Senses darkvision 60 ft., tremorsense 30 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages understands its handler, speaks none

Traits

Sand Veil. Dust curls constantly from its plates. Attack rolls against Sandshrew made from more than 15 feet away have Disadvantage.

Curl and Guard. *Reaction, 15 ft.* When an ally it can see is hit by an attack, Sandshrew rolls into the path and becomes the target instead. It takes the damage, reduced by 5.

Actions

Multiattack. It makes two Claw attacks.

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 10 (1d10 + 5) slashing damage.

Spike Field. Sandshrew churns the ground into a bristling field: a 20-foot Cube centered on itself. The field does not move with it and lasts until the start of Sandshrew's next turn. The area is Difficult Terrain, and a creature takes 5 (2d4) piercing damage for every 5 feet it moves inside it.

